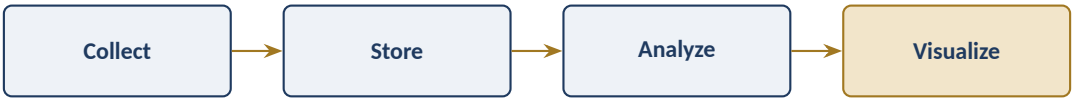
Business Intelligence Overview

AnalystLab Africa • Global Superstore Analysis • Week 2

What Business Intelligence is

Business Intelligence (BI) is the set of processes and tools a company uses to collect, store, analyze and present its data so people can act on it. Nobody wants to read through thousands of rows in a ledger. BI turns those rows into visuals that show *what is happening* in the business right now, and it helps leaders connect past patterns to what they should do next.



Why executive dashboards matter

Companies build dashboards to bring data from different places into one view that everyone trusts. A good executive dashboard does three things:

- **Saves time.** It replaces big static spreadsheets with reports that refresh on their own.
- **Speeds up decisions.** Leaders can spot spikes, drops and outliers straight away instead of digging for them.
- **Lets managers answer their own questions.** Non-technical people can filter by year, region and so on, without waiting on the IT team.

Business objective

I worked on this as a Junior BI Analyst at AnalystLab Africa. This report and the interactive dashboard that goes with it were built for a national retail company, using the Global Superstore data.

The goal is to study its historical global performance and understand where the business stands. The numbers I started from are below.

$12.64M	$1.47M	11.61%	$246.49
Total sales	Total profit	Profit margin	Average sales

From there, the analysis looks at:

- how each region is growing,
- how much each customer segment contributes,
- which sub-categories are the most and least profitable, and
- where the business is losing efficiency.

The findings are meant to guide expansion plans and how resources are shared out.